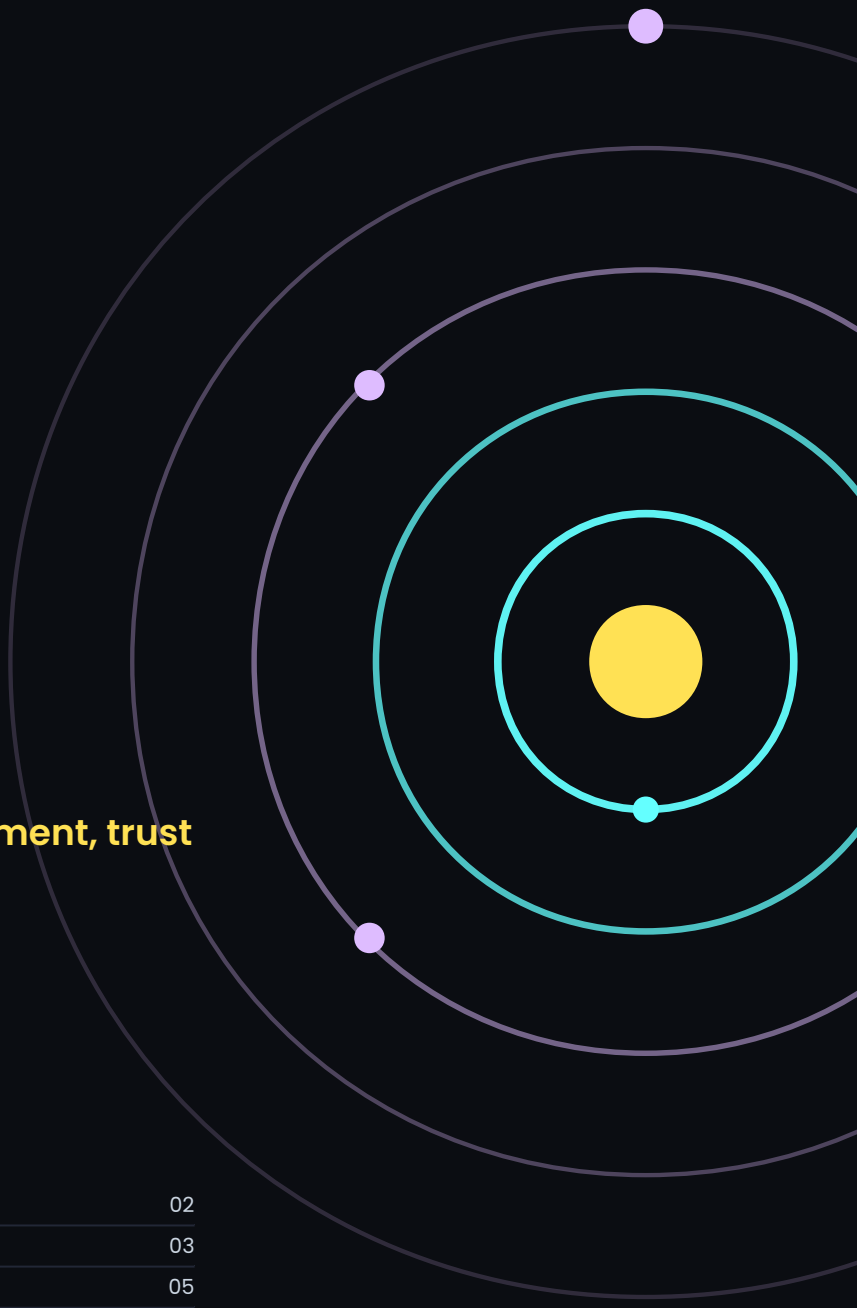
BOW META

The Power Circle Protocol



Build stronger circles through alignment, trust and discernment.

Show up. Contribute. Connect. Amplify.

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PART I · THE FOUNDATION

1. Understanding the Power Circle

Your Power Circle is the collection of people, relationships, communities and institutions that influence your capacity to think, decide, create, execute and grow.

It is not simply your friends, followers, colleagues or supporters. It is your relational ecosystem.

Every person in that ecosystem has some combination of:

Access · **Influence** · **Expertise** · **Resources** · **Information** · **Emotional impact** · **Social capital** · **Opportunity** · **Reputation** · **Decision-making power**

The purpose of this protocol is to understand how those forces interact.

The five pillars

1
Alignment
Shared values, vision, objectives and direction.

2
Trust
Reliability, integrity, psychological safety and consistency.

3
Discernment
The ability to distinguish genuine alignment from attraction, convenience, projection or opportunism.

4
Contribution
Reciprocity, generosity, accountability and demonstrated value.

5
Collective Power
The ability to coordinate relationships, resources and capabilities toward meaningful outcomes.

2. The psychological premise

Relationships are not psychologically neutral. People bring needs, fears, ambitions, insecurities, histories, expectations and competing incentives into every relationship. These forces influence:

- What people communicate.
- What they conceal.
- What they reward.
- What they compete over.
- What they interpret as rejection.
- How they respond to boundaries.
- Whether they celebrate another person's success.
- Whether they can tolerate disagreement.

A high-performance circle requires more than good intentions. It requires psychological awareness.

The objective is not to judge people's character. It is to observe patterns of behaviour, identify relational dynamics and make better decisions.

PART II · MAP YOUR CIRCLE

3. The Circle Architecture

Start by identifying the different layers of your ecosystem. Write a name beside each question.

CIRCLE ONE Inner Circle

People with whom you share substantial trust, vulnerability, influence or responsibility.

QUESTIONS

Who knows the real version of you? _____

Who can challenge you without threatening the relationship? _____

Who has earned access to your private thoughts and plans? _____

Who demonstrates consistency when there is nothing to gain? _____

Who can be trusted with your vulnerability? _____

CIRCLE TWO Strategic Circle

People who contribute to your mission, professional growth, opportunities or strategic direction.

QUESTIONS

Who opens doors? _____

Who shares knowledge and resources? _____

Who has complementary capabilities? _____

Who makes your work better? _____

Who can execute alongside you? _____

CIRCLE THREE Influence Circle

People who shape your visibility, reputation, access and positioning.

QUESTIONS

Who influences how others perceive you? _____

Who amplifies your work? _____

Who introduces you to new networks? _____

Who has access to decision-makers? _____

Who can influence opportunities without directly participating? _____

CIRCLE FOUR Community Circle

The broader network of supporters, collaborators, peers, audiences and emerging relationships.

QUESTIONS

Who consistently engages? _____

Who contributes to collective momentum? _____

Who could become a strategic collaborator? _____

Who needs greater visibility or opportunity? _____

CIRCLE FIVE Peripheral or Unaligned

Relationships that are limited, transactional, uncertain, competitive or no longer aligned.

QUESTIONS

What is the actual nature of this relationship? _____

Is access appropriate? _____

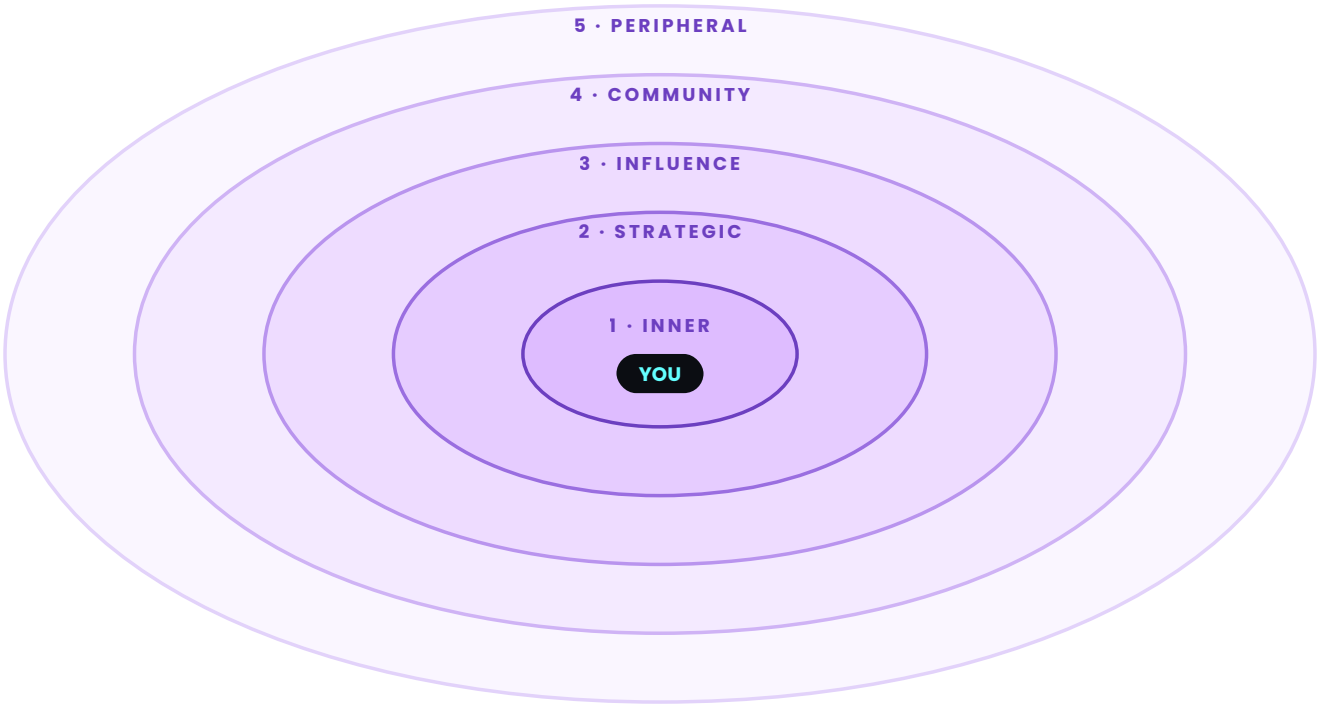
Is the relationship neutral, beneficial or costly? _____

Does it need a boundary, clarification or less investment? _____

PART II · EXERCISE

Exercise: Map your people.

> Write down 5–10 people in each layer. Do not assign someone to the inner circle simply because of history, intimacy, status or potential.



- **Circle One · Inner**
- **Circle Two · Strategic**
- **Circle Three · Influence**
- **Circle Four · Community**
- **Circle Five · Peripheral or Unaligned**

Access should reflect demonstrated trust.

PART III · THE PSYCHOLOGICAL AUDIT

4. The Seven Psychological Dimensions

> This is the heart of the protocol. Tick Y or N for each audit question.

A Attachment and Belonging

People seek connection, recognition, security and belonging. These needs can influence how they behave in professional and personal relationships.

AUDIT

- Y N Do I feel secure or anxious in this relationship?
- Y N Do I change my behaviour to maintain someone's approval?
- Y N Am I afraid of losing access?
- Y N Do I confuse intensity with intimacy?
- Y N Do I overinvest when someone withdraws?
- Y N Can I tolerate distance without chasing reassurance?

Watch for: anxious pursuit, avoidance, overdependence, approval-seeking and fear of exclusion.

Development principle: Belonging should not require self-abandonment.

B Projection and Idealization

Projection occurs when we attribute our own expectations, fears or assumptions to another person.

Idealization occurs when we elevate someone's perceived qualities beyond what their behaviour has demonstrated.

AUDIT

- Y N What do I actually know about this person?
- Y N What am I assuming?
- Y N Am I responding to their behaviour or their potential?
- Y N Have I built a story around what this relationship could become?
- Y N Am I overlooking contradictions because I want the relationship to work?

Watch for: imagined loyalty, imagined partnership, inflated expectations and confirmation bias.

Development principle: Evaluate people through repeated behaviour, not imagined potential.

C Power, Status and Recognition

Every network contains formal and informal power.

Power can come from money, access, reputation, expertise, social positioning, ownership or control of opportunities.

AUDIT

- [Y] [N] Who has decision-making power?
- [Y] [N] Who controls access?
- [Y] [N] Who receives recognition?
- [Y] [N] Who does the work?
- [Y] [N] Who benefits from the work?
- [Y] [N] Are responsibilities and rewards proportionate?
- [Y] [N] Does someone use proximity to power to influence others?

Watch for: status games, gatekeeping, credit appropriation, hierarchy manipulation and unequal exchanges.

Development principle: Understand the power structure before committing your resources.

D Reciprocity and Resource Exchange

Healthy relationships do not require perfectly equal transactions. They do require a sustainable form of mutual contribution.

AUDIT

- [Y] [N] Who initiates?
- [Y] [N] Who follows through?
- [Y] [N] Who provides introductions?
- [Y] [N] Who shares opportunities?
- [Y] [N] Who offers expertise?
- [Y] [N] Who supports my success?
- [Y] [N] Am I consistently giving more than I can sustain?
- [Y] [N] Can I ask for something without feeling indebted or ashamed?

Watch for: chronic extraction, one-sided emotional labour, invisible work and entitlement.

Development principle: Generosity creates value. Boundaries protect its sustainability.

E Emotional Regulation and Psychological Safety

A powerful circle must be able to withstand discomfort.

Psychological safety is not the absence of disagreement. It is the ability to speak, question, challenge and repair without disproportionate punishment.

AUDIT

- [Y] [N] Can I express disagreement?
- [Y] [N] Can I say no?
- [Y] [N] Can I admit mistakes?
- [Y] [N] Does conflict lead to understanding or retaliation?
- [Y] [N] Do I feel compelled to manage another person's emotions?
- [Y] [N] Can both parties take responsibility?

Watch for: intimidation, emotional volatility, silent treatment, public humiliation, retaliation and chronic defensiveness.

Development principle: Healthy relationships allow difficult conversations without making connection conditional on compliance.

F Competition, Envy and Social Comparison

People can simultaneously admire, support and compete with one another.
This is particularly important in leadership, entrepreneurial and high-visibility communities.

AUDIT

- Y N Can this person celebrate my success?
- Y N Do I celebrate theirs?
- Y N Does collaboration become competitive when recognition is involved?
- Y N Are opportunities shared or hoarded?
- Y N Does someone undermine another person's contribution?
- Y N Is there room for multiple people to succeed?

Watch for: scarcity thinking, covert competition, status anxiety and sabotage.

Development principle: Build environments where collective success expands individual opportunity.

G Identity, Values and Integrity

Relationships influence identity.
The people around you can reinforce your highest standards or gradually normalize behaviour that contradicts them.

AUDIT

- Y N Do I respect who I become around this person?
- Y N Are my values strengthened or compromised?
- Y N Can I maintain my convictions?
- Y N Does this relationship encourage growth?
- Y N Am I performing a version of myself to maintain access?
- Y N Would I be comfortable publicly defending the way this relationship operates?

Watch for: identity erosion, moral compromise, performative loyalty and values drift.

Development principle: Your circle should support who you are becoming, not require you to betray what matters.

Dimension notes

Dimension	Relationship it shows up in	Pattern I noticed
A · Attachment and Belonging		
B · Projection and Idealization		
C · Power, Status and Recognition		
D · Reciprocity and Resource Exchange		
E · Emotional Regulation and Safety		
F · Competition, Envy and Comparison		
G · Identity, Values and Integrity		

PART IV · THE RELATIONSHIP AUDIT

5. The Individual Relationship Scorecard

> Complete one assessment for every significant person in your circle.

Person: _____ **Relationship:** _____ **Time known:** _____

Primary context: ☐ Personal ☐ Professional ☐ Strategic ☐ Community ☐ Partnership

USE A SCORE FROM 1–5 **1** = Seriously deficient · **2** = Inconsistent · **3** = Mixed or uncertain · **4** = Strong · **5** = Consistently demonstrated

Rate each dimension (1–5)	Score
Shared values	/ 5
Strategic alignment	/ 5
Trustworthiness	/ 5
Reliability	/ 5
Reciprocity	/ 5
Emotional safety	/ 5
Respect for boundaries	/ 5
Integrity under pressure	/ 5
Celebration of mutual success	/ 5
Constructive conflict resolution	/ 5
Total	/ 50

Interpret the result

42–50
Strong demonstrated alignment.

33–41
Promising, with areas to examine.

23–32
Mixed relationship; clarify expectations.

10–22
Significant concerns; reassess access and investment.

> *These are reflection thresholds, not validated psychological measurements. A high score does not override serious concerns in any individual dimension.*

PART IV · THE RELATIONSHIP AUDIT

Behavioural evidence

What have they consistently demonstrated?

What remains uncertain?

What do I need to communicate?

What boundary or adjustment might improve this relationship?

What would need to happen to increase trust?

More scorecards

Score more of your significant people here, using the same ten dimensions and the same 1–5 scale.

Person	Values	Strategic	Trust	Reliable	Recipro.	Safety	Bound.	Integrity	Celebr.	Conflict	Total /50

PART V · THE SHADOW AUDIT

6. What Are You Bringing Into the Circle?

> This section is equally important. It is easy to audit everyone else's behaviour while avoiding our own patterns. Leadership requires self-awareness.

The personal psychological audit

Approval

- [Y] [N] Do I need particular people to validate my value?
- [Y] [N] Do I overperform to secure recognition?

Abandonment

- [Y] [N] Does distance trigger disproportionate anxiety?
- [Y] [N] Do I pursue relationships that have become inconsistent?

Control

- [Y] [N] Do I struggle when people make independent decisions?
- [Y] [N] Can I allow others to disagree without interpreting it as disloyalty?

Resentment

- [Y] [N] Where am I giving more than I genuinely want to give?
- [Y] [N] Have I communicated my expectations?
- [Y] [N] Am I keeping an invisible ledger of what people owe me?

Recognition

- [Y] [N] Do I need public acknowledgment?
- [Y] [N] Can I contribute without immediate visibility?
- [Y] [N] Am I appropriately advocating for my own work?

Competition

- [Y] [N] Can I make room for others to lead?
- [Y] [N] Do I experience another person's success as a threat?

Boundaries

- [Y] [N] Do I say yes when I mean no?
- [Y] [N] Do I withdraw instead of communicating?
- [Y] [N] Can I repair a relationship after conflict?

PART V · THE SHADOW AUDIT

The trigger-to-action exercise

> For a difficult interaction, complete:

1. **What happened?** *(Observable facts only.)*

2. **What did I interpret it to mean?**

3. **What emotion or physical response followed?**

4. **What underlying need or fear might have been activated?**

5. **What alternative explanation is possible?**

6. **What response would reflect my values?**

7. **What action is actually required?**

Remember: A feeling is valid information about your experience. It is not automatically proof of another person's intention.

PART VI · POWER, INFLUENCE AND NETWORK DYNAMICS

7. The Influence Map

> Identify where power actually resides. For each person, assess each source of power: H (high), M (medium) or L (low).

Person	Decision authority	Financial resources	Expertise	Network access	Reputation	Information access	Ability to mobilize people	Ability to create opportunities
	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L
	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L
	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L
	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L
	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L
	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L
	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L
	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L	H M L

Then ask:

1. Who connects otherwise disconnected groups? _____
2. Who is the trusted source of information? _____
3. Who influences decisions without holding formal authority? _____
4. Who consistently creates opportunities for others? _____
5. Who receives the benefits of collective labour? _____
6. Who is missing from important conversations? _____
7. Where is the network overly dependent on one individual? _____

The hidden power audit

Look beyond titles. A person may have little formal authority but enormous relational influence. Another may hold a senior title but have limited trust or ability to mobilize people. Distinguish:

Positional power **Relational power** **Informational power** **Economic power** **Cultural power**

Execution power

The objective is to understand the actual architecture of influence, not merely the visible hierarchy.

PART VII · THE COLLECTIVE AUDIT

8. Is Your Circle Actually Powerful?

> A network is not powerful simply because it contains impressive people. It becomes powerful when relationships produce coordinated outcomes. Evaluate the collective:

Measure	Strong	Mixed	Weak	Evidence / notes
Shared vision	☐	☐	☐	
Trust across the network	☐	☐	☐	
Information sharing	☐	☐	☐	
Opportunity distribution	☐	☐	☐	
Recognition of contribution	☐	☐	☐	
Conflict resolution	☐	☐	☐	
Collaboration	☐	☐	☐	
Accountability	☐	☐	☐	
Leadership development	☐	☐	☐	
Collective execution	☐	☐	☐	

Five network failure patterns

- ☐ **1. The Extraction Network** — People consume resources, attention and labour without meaningful contribution.
- ☐ **2. The Status Network** — Visibility and proximity to influential people matter more than actual work.
- ☐ **3. The Fragmented Network** — People operate in silos, withholding information and competing for access.
- ☐ **4. The Dependency Network** — Too much authority, information or execution rests with one person.
- ☐ **5. The Performative Network** — Public support is strong, but private accountability and practical contribution are weak.

Tick any pattern you recognize in your circle.

Five characteristics of a high-performance circle

- ☐ Shared purpose.
- ☐ Distributed leadership.
- ☐ Reciprocal opportunity.
- ☐ Constructive disagreement.
- ☐ Collective accountability.

PART VIII · REBUILDING AND STRENGTHENING THE CIRCLE

9. The Discernment Matrix

> Not every relationship needs the same response.

Relationship pattern	Appropriate response	Who fits this pattern?
High trust, high alignment	Invest and deepen	
High trust, low alignment	Maintain respect; clarify direction	
Low trust, high potential	Build slowly; verify behaviour	
Low trust, low alignment	Reduce investment and access	
High contribution, poor boundaries	Renegotiate expectations	
Strong influence, weak integrity	Limit dependence and exposure	
High intimacy, inconsistent reliability	Slow down and establish evidence	

The four possible actions

DEEPEN
Increase investment, collaboration and responsibility.
Who:

DEVELOP
Create opportunities to build trust and capability.
Who:

RECALIBRATE
Clarify expectations, roles, boundaries and reciprocity.
Who:

DISTANCE
Reduce access, dependence or involvement where necessary.
Who:

Remember: Do not confuse a difficult season with a permanent character assessment. Look for patterns, context and willingness to repair.

PART IX · THE POWER CIRCLE DEVELOPMENT PLAN

10. Your 30-Day Circle Strategy

Week 1 Awareness

- [ ] Map your existing circle.
- [ ] Identify the five most influential relationships.
- [ ] Complete individual scorecards.
- [ ] Identify your own relational patterns.
- [ ] Recognize the biggest gaps.

Week 2 Discernment

- [ ] Identify relationships requiring clarification.
- [ ] Examine contribution and reciprocity.
- [ ] Identify where boundaries are missing.
- [ ] Determine which relationships deserve greater investment.

Week 3 Activation

- [ ] Make three meaningful introductions.
- [ ] Share two opportunities.
- [ ] Publicly recognize meaningful contributions.
- [ ] Initiate one important conversation.
- [ ] Reconnect with one aligned person.

Week 4 Consolidation

- [ ] Evaluate the quality of interactions.
- [ ] Establish clearer responsibilities.
- [ ] Strengthen strategic partnerships.
- [ ] Identify emerging leaders.
- [ ] Measure what has actually changed.

My 30-day commitments

The three relationships I will strengthen:

The conversation I need to have:

The boundary I need to establish:

The opportunity I can create for someone else:

The contribution I need to recognize:

The relationship I need to reassess:

PART X · THE BOW META CODE

11. The Principles of Collective Power

Kindness is our superpower.

Kindness is not weakness, compliance or the absence of boundaries. It is a deliberate commitment to creating value and treating people with dignity.

The protocol

1. **Show up with intention.**
2. **Contribute before demanding.**
3. **Connect people who should know one another.**
4. **Amplify meaningful work.**
5. **Share opportunities.**
6. **Recognize contribution.**
7. **Protect trust.**
8. **Respect boundaries.**
9. **Develop new leaders.**
10. **Build something greater than individual recognition.**

The ultimate measure

- [ ] Y [ ] N Does your circle make its members stronger?
- [ ] Y [ ] N Does it create access where there was previously exclusion?
- [ ] Y [ ] N Does it transform individual talent into collective capability?
- [ ] Y [ ] N Does it produce meaningful outcomes?
- [ ] Y [ ] N Does it allow people to grow without requiring them to diminish someone else?

The strongest circle is not the one with the most powerful individuals. It is the one that knows how to create power together.

FINAL REFLECTION

Final Reflection

> Complete these statements:

I want my circle to represent:

The values I refuse to compromise:

The people I want to become better through:

The contribution I want to be known for:

The legacy I want this network to create:

BOW META

Show up. Contribute. Connect. Amplify.

Build stronger circles through alignment, trust and discernment.

Build what matters.

UP NEXT · WORKBOOK 02 **Narrative Gravity** **Veemeta.com**

The series: **Power Circle Protocol** · Narrative Gravity · Building Atmosphere · Building Momentum · Building Authority